

Panasonic Shinobi Pro PX950 Mini LED

Bright 4K HDR performance at a premium price

₹1,70,000

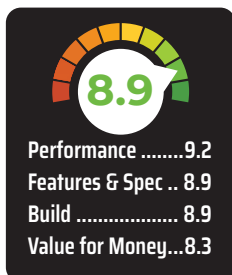


Panasonic's 65-inch TH-65PX950DX

Mini LED TV is a premium mid-range TV and a part of its Shinobi Pro series. At its current price of about Rs 1,70,000, the TV offers flagship features like a 4K HDR panel with quantum dots, a proprietary colour engine and support for Dolby Vision, HDR10+, 66W speakers with built-in tweeter, Dolby Atmos, HDMI 2.1 and Google TV software. We have extensively used these features for some time now, and here's how the Mini LED TV stacks up for the asking price.

DISPLAY TEST

The Panasonic PX950 Mini LED TV is available in two screen sizes in India: a 75-inch model and a 65-inch model, which is our review unit, sent to us by the brand. Based on our tests and over 2,000:1 contrast ratio, the TV appears



to have an IPS-Black panel. This and the Mini LED backlighting offer deep blacks and rich colours at 4K resolution.

The viewing angles are fine, and there is no noticeable backlight bleeding.

In our lab tests using a Colourimeter and professional-grade Calman software, the TV reached a peak luminance of 661 nits in HDR (Vivid picture) mode, while black levels were recorded at 0.31 nits (HDR). This results in a contrast ratio of around 2,132:1, which is decent for an IPS-based Mini LED display. The Mini LED backlighting helps reduce blooming around bright highlights, but the light precision isn't as good as our reference device.

Colour performance is one of the PX950's strengths. In SDR mode, the TV covers 93.6% of the BT.709 colour gamut, which ensures natural and balanced tones for regular TV shows, news, and cable content. In HDR mode,

it reproduces 97.13% of the UHDA-P3 gamut (similar to DCI-P3) and 81.13% of the wider BT.2020 spectrum, which is impressive. Colours appear rich but not oversaturated, and skin tones maintain realism across different lighting.

In our colour accuracy test, the TV returned an average Delta E of 4.6 in SDR and 2.5 in HDR. A lower Delta E value indicates better colour accuracy, so the HDR results here are quite good, while SDR could use some fine-tuning for precise colour fidelity.

Let's now see how these figures translate to real-world viewing:

VIEWING EXPERIENCE

In real-world viewing, we used the Movie mode to get closer to the creator's intent, though the TV also offers other modes such as Vivid, Sports, Energy Saving, and Game. We kept MEMC off to avoid the soap opera effect and preserve natural motion.

During testing, the Panasonic PX950 performed consistently across different content types. In The Revenant, the fire scene showed a faint halo around bright flames. The effect wasn't distracting, but it was visible in dark backgrounds.

In the docking scene from the movie Interstellar, the sweat and facial features of Matthew McConaughey, and the glowing event horizon of a nearby black hole (Gargantua) resembled the reference screen. In Dunkirk, too, the bright light sources and fire explosions were sharp and well-controlled, though not as precise or contrast-rich as on our reference display.

Motion handling in Gemini Man was fine, with no visible judder or tearing, but it's worth noting that the PX950 supports only a 60Hz native refresh rate. You could get a 120Hz panel from competing models in this price range, which provide smoother motion in fast-paced action scenes or gaming.

Overall, the Panasonic PX950 delivers strong brightness and wide colour coverage that enhance HDR playback, supported by the benefits of Mini LED backlighting. However, given